

CAULIFLOWER *Brassica oleracea* Botrytis Group

Cauliflowers require an investment of both time and space, since they can stay in the ground for up to a year, taking up a relatively large amount of ground. If you keep them well-watered and can persuade them not to bolt, they will produce striking white, purple, or even lime-green heads, or “curds.” With careful planning, you can ensure a delicious crop, which can be cooked or eaten raw in salads, all year round.

	SPRING	SUMMER	FALL	WINTER
SOW/PLANT				
HARVEST				

SOWING

Cauliflowers prefer fertile soil with a pH of no less than 6.8, so add lime to the soil, if necessary. Fully grown heads, or “curds,” will eventually become quite heavy, so cauliflowers need a firm soil to support them.

Ensure that crops are rotated, and do not plant cauliflower where any brassicas have been grown in the last three years.

Cauliflowers can be grown to produce a year-round harvest: sow seeds in fall or winter to produce an early summer crop; sow in spring for a summer and fall crop; sow in late spring for a winter or spring crop.

Sow in pots or module trays at a depth of .75 in (2 cm) and keep indoors or under a cloche or cold



Use a cloche to protect young seedlings.

frame to protect from frost and to encourage germination.

PLANTING

Do not let seedlings grow taller than 2 in (5 cm) before you plant them out, or you will risk damaging the roots; this might encourage plants to bolt.

Cauliflowers need space to grow, and generally the later you plant them, the more space they